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EngageKit

Spring 2026

Founders

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Founders

Ky Nam Nguyen 🔒 Profile complete

Basics

Name	Email	Phone Number
Ky Nam Nguyen	knamnguyen.work@gmail.com	+85270720048

Age	Gender	City where you currently live
24	Male	Ho Chi Minh City, Ho Chi Minh City, VN

Role

What is your title, or if you haven't set it yet, main responsibility?

CEO

What percent equity do you have?

50

Do you have at least 10% equity in the company you're applying with?

yes

Are you a technical founder?

yes

Are you currently in school?

no

If accepted to YC, will you commit to working exclusively on this project for the next year?

yes

Background

Your LinkedIn URL

<https://www.linkedin.com/in/withkynam/>

Education

The University of Hong Kong BA, Computer Science	Sep 2022 - May 2024
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Sciences Po BA, Economics And Politics	Sep 2020 - May 2022
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Work Experience

buildstuffs.com - Founder & Host	Jan 2025 - Dec 2025
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I founded the largest indie hackers network in Ho Chi Minh City - where we host biweekly co-building sessions for builders, growth hackers and tech enthusiast along with an exclusive group chat for founders support. The movement quickly spread to Hanoi and Da Nang where we connected with Hacka, UpYouth, and Hacker Residency Group to host mutual events. We have hosted over 1000 hackers and 50+ cobuilding sessions, with more to come in 2026.

sayu.studio - COO	May 2024 - Feb 2025
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Acquired 60+ leads and closed 20 deals, bringing in \$100,000 revenue. Built clients' websites on webflow and shopify engine with raw javascript and framework (anime.js, barba.js, etc) and boosted their conversion rate by 50%. 3 clients got featured on <https://www.awwwards.com/sayustudio/>

AS Watson - Digital Transformation Consultant	Aug 2023 - Apr 2024
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- Built 3 demos with the IT team for an LLM chatbot for sustainability education for 10,000 employees to track sustainability metrics - Created the first production-ready version of the chatbot with agentic capabilities to demo to Chief Sustainability Officer. - Automated with RPA the research of thousands of documents for chatbot's knowledge base, including scraping 5000 pages of CDP project from 200+ competitors to AS Watson

LEAN Social - Co-Founder / CEO	Jun 2022 - Jul 2023
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This is my first startup with my bro Zi Hao Lam - a study-with-me platform for GenZ. We built and launched 3 versions of the product in 3 months, won a few regional awards, got to 5000 users, built an online community group of 50k members, and sold everything for 50,000 USD. We have been building different web apps and have launched 4 products every since.

Vinfast JSC - Technology Consultant	Mar 2021 - Oct 2021
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I reported to the Vice-chairwoman of a 10-billion-dollar Vietnamese company to draft reports on incentive policies to expand our EV arm into the US and EU market. I also vetted and worked with partners at Amazon, Cherry, and Idra along with Engineering team to improve our cars to fit international standard requirements

Duke University - Research Lead	Jan 2021 - Aug 2023
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Led first RCT political voting experiment with 1000 youths in Ho Chi Minh City - funded by Duke University under Prof. Edmund Malesky. This is the first study of its kind under a communist regime to use information design and data analysis to inspect trends in voters' behaviours. Published in the Journal of Politics at The University of Chicago <https://doi.org/10.1086/739565>

Personal website

<https://withkynam.com>

Twitter URL

<https://x.com/withkynam>

Github URL

<https://github.com/knamnguyen>

Accomplishments

Please tell us about a time you most successfully hacked some (non-computer) system to your advantage.

I had no money for ads, no network in tech, and no audience. So I reverse-engineered what goes viral on social media and started writing — brutally honest, sometimes unhinged, always funny content about building startups from Southeast Asia.

40M+ impressions in 6 months. 20M on X, 8M on Reddit (mostly hate threads about me lol), 4M on Threads, 2M on LinkedIn. \$0 ad spend.

That traffic converted into actual things: \$100K in web agency revenue for my studio, early users for EngageKit, and — this is the weird part — the U.S. State Department noticed and selected me as a YSEALI Fellow, flew me to Nevada to network with entrepreneurs across Southeast Asia.

Same playbook also helped me build buildstuffs.com — now the largest indie hackers network in Vietnam. 1,000+ builders, 50+ co-building sessions, 3 cities.

Turns out if you can hack distribution with \$0, everything else gets easier.

Please tell us in one or two sentences about the most impressive thing other than this startup that you have built or achieved.

I built buildstuffs.com — Vietnam's largest indie hackers network (1,000+ builders, 50+ sessions, 3 cities) — because I'm obsessed with the idea that when one builder makes it, they pull others up too.

I publicly gave up my entire family inheritance to a scholarship fund for young builders because I believe the best founders start from zero, not from safety nets. Declaration: <https://www.facebook.com/share/p/14TtD2wpFBL/>

Tell us about things you've built before. For example apps you've built, websites, open source contributions. Include URLs if possible.

EngageKit: human-in-the-loop LinkedIn engagement Chrome extension. 1,000 installs, 100 paid users, \$2K lifetime revenue. live on Chrome Web Store. <https://engagekit.co>

LinkStrip: Chrome extension that stripped ads and noise from LinkedIn feeds. LinkedIn sent me a cease-and-desist letter for this one — which is how I learned exactly where the platform draws the line. EngageKit is built on that lesson. <https://github.com/knamnguyen/LinkStrip>

Chastack: "substack but for group chats" — syncs any group chat into a dashboard with member participation stats, daily summaries, and paywall features. built on Matrix protocol. <https://github.com/knamnguyen/chatstack.co>

Riper-5-SDD: cursor/claude-compatible rule system for spec-driven development. way simpler than spec-kit. used by devs to keep AI code output clean and documented. <https://github.com/knamnguyen/riper-5-spec-driven-development>

Turbo-T3-Sassy: monorepo SaaS boilerplate — plug in your Supabase/Clerk/Stripe keys, run scripts, ship a SaaS in hours not weeks. <https://github.com/knamnguyen/turbo-t3-sassy>

viralcut.app: takes your product demo, auto-picks the best snippets, slaps a proven viral hook in front, spits out a 15s TikTok-ready video. <https://github.com/knamnguyen/viralcut>

gifavatar.app: makes animated gif avatars for Gmail + 12 other platforms. 2x email response rate, minimum. <https://github.com/knamnguyen/gifavatar>

iVatar: 3D digital twin — characters with lip-synced audio, 1,000+ actions, 100+ facial expressions. sold it for \$5,000. <https://github.com/knamnguyen/ivatar-official>

FakeMetrics: Chrome extension that fakes social media / payment screenshots (survives page refresh). built it to show how easy it is to scam people with fake proof online. educational rage-bait lol. <https://github.com/knamnguyen/fakemetrics>

TikTok human simulator: bot that watches TikTok, scrapes hashtags, dumps data to Google Sheets so you can reverse-engineer the algo. <https://github.com/knamnguyen/TikTok-human-simulator-bot-based-on-keyword-hashtag>

Websites — at SAYU Studio (\$100K revenue, 20 deals closed) i built e-commerce sites, 3 featured on Awwwards. <https://posthmlab.com/> | <https://meau.co/>

List any competitions/awards you have won, or papers you've published.

Startup & Tech:

Selected AI Startup Entrepreneur — YSEALI, U.S. Department of State 2025 - \$20,000 grant
Best AI Product (iVatar) — Kazan Youth Summit Global, Russia - \$5000 grant
Startup Incubator Grantee — Hong Kong Science and Technology Parks Corporation 2024 - \$14,000 grant
Startup Incubator Grantee — Cyberport Hong Kong 2023 - \$14,000 grant
Top 1 in Digital Transformation — Prometheus Europe 2022 - \$3,000 grant
Top 20 — University Startup World Cup 2022 - \$2,000 grant
Top 6 — Hult Prize Startup Asia 2022 - \$2,000 grant
Urban Innovation Fellow — MIT Hong Kong Innovation Node - \$4,000 grant
Youth Fellow 2023 (Real Impact on Society and Environment Award) - \$2,000 grant

"Information Design and Political Participation Under Authoritarianism" — Journal of Politics, University of Chicago Press (<https://doi.org/10.1086/739565>). first RCT voting experiment in a single-party communist regime. i was 21. - \$12,000 grant

List any relevant or impressive test scores.

I got 1570/1600 on the SAT years ago lol. I teach SAT when we run out of money.

List any entrepreneurship programs, clubs, or hacker houses you have participated in or are currently participating in.

buildstuffs.com (founder) — i started the largest indie hackers network in Vietnam. biweekly co-building sessions for builders and growth hackers across Ho Chi Minh City, Hanoi, and Da Nang. 1,000+ hackers, 50+ sessions. partnered with Hacka, UpYouth, and Hacker Residency Group. we also run a daily group chat where builders share wins, problems, and roast each other's code.

YSEALI (Young Southeast Asian Leaders Initiative) — selected by the U.S. State Department, sent to Nevada for an entrepreneurship fellowship. networked with founders and operators across SEA and the US.

UpYouth (mentor & alumni) — Vietnam's first startup incubator for founders under 25. i mentor builders and we host sessions regularly. UpYouth got into Forbes 30 Under 30 Asia.

Zi Hao Lam

Profile complete



Basics

Name	Email	Phone Number
Zi Hao Lam	lamzihao98@gmail.com	+60122562048

Age	Gender	City where you currently live
28	Male	Kuala Lumpur, Federal Territory of Kuala Lumpur, MY

Role

What is your title, or if you haven't set it yet, main responsibility?

CTO

What percent equity do you have?

50

Do you have at least 10% equity in the company you're applying with?

yes

Are you a technical founder?

yes

Are you currently in school?

no

If accepted to YC, will you commit to working exclusively on this project for the next year?

yes

Background

Your LinkedIn URL

<https://www.linkedin.com/in/zi-hao-lam/>

Education

The University of Hong Kong BA, Computer Science	Jan 2018 - Jan 2022
HELP University International a levels, 4a*	Jan 2015 - Jan 2016

Work Experience

Likelabs.io - Senior Software Engineer Building web3 alternative to OnlyFans (https://w.ink). Full-stack engineering on creator monetization and content infrastructure.	Feb 2025 - Dec 2025
Luda Development HK Limited - Senior Software Engineer Built AI agents that saved ~10 man-hours/staff/week on data entry. Led team building internal analytics and KPI tools. Technical work directly contributed to the company's Nasdaq IPO (Ticker: LUD) — helped shape the technical positioning in the prospectus.	Aug 2023 - Jan 2025
Amazon Web Services (AWS) - Solutions Architect First junior hire and youngest on the team. Led technical side of government cloud migrations totaling ~\$7M. Contributed to migration strategy for the AWS Kuala Lumpur Region launch. Learned 50+ AWS services in first month to a level where I was running technical workshops for senior engineers at customer companies.	Aug 2022 - Aug 2023
Societe Generale Investment Bank - Software Developer Intern	Dec 2021 - Feb 2022
Amazon Web Services (AWS) - Solution Architect Intern	Jun 2021 - Aug 2021

Social Media

Personal website

<https://github.com/zihaolam>

Twitter URL

<https://x.com/lamzihao>

Github URL

<https://github.com/zihaolam>

Accomplishments

Please tell us about a time you most successfully hacked some (non-computer) system to your advantage.

Student visa in Hong Kong limits you to 20 hours/week of work. Freelancing isn't allowed. But I needed money, family couldn't cover my living costs.

So I put my mother on Upwork. Her name, her credit card, her profile. She became the oldest web developer on the platform. I did the work, she collected the payments. Multiple clients, good money and no visa violation (technically). That freelancing income plus a tutoring gig kept me alive through 4 years at HKU on a full tuition scholarship.

Please tell us in one or two sentences about the most impressive thing other than this startup that you have built or achieved.

At 22, I was the youngest solutions architect at AWS Malaysia and the first junior hire on the team. Within a year, I was leading the technical side of government cloud migrations, classified data, strict sovereignty policies, deals totaling ~\$4M. I also helped shape the migration playbooks for the AWS Kuala Lumpur Region launch, which defined how Malaysia's entire government sector would onboard to their first local AWS infrastructure.

Tell us about things you've built before. For example apps you've built, websites, open source contributions. Include URLs if possible.

EngageKit — human-in-the-loop LinkedIn engagement tool (Chrome extension). I built the full stack: sidebar UI, AI draft generation pipeline, engagement history DB, analytics dashboard, target list system. 1,000 installs, 100 paid users.
<https://engagekit.co>

Browser-native vector memory for LLMs — local vector DB that runs entirely in-browser, giving LLMs persistent memory with zero backend. No server, no API calls, everything client-side.
<https://github.com/zilhaolam/vector-memory>

AI-powered LMS — learning management system with multi-language auto-transcription and dubbing. Built the full media processing pipeline from scratch.
<https://github.com/zilhaolam/lms>
<https://github.com/zilhaolam/media-processing>

AI video editor — subtitle/transcript/speech editor with automatic translation and AI dubbing.
<https://github.com/zilhaolam/tts-editor>

Pothole detection via dashcam — CV model that detects road damage in real-time from dashcam footage.
<https://github.com/zilhaolam/roadwarrior>

LEAN Social — study-together platform with gamification. Built with Ky-Nam. Grew to 5,000 users, sold for \$50,000.
<https://youtu.be/H8xHtnocmYQ>

Studtors — tuition center directory with bookings, scheduling, and payments. Production app with paying customers.
<https://studtors.com>

Tutupay — payments SaaS for tuition centers. Fee collection, notifications, accounting reports.
<https://tutuhub.tech>

List any competitions/awards you have won, or papers you've published.

Startup Incubator Grantee (~14K USD) - Hong Kong Science and Technology Parks Corporation 2024
Startup Incubator Grantee (~14K USD) - Cyberport Hong Kong 2023
Full Scholarship - Bachelors Degree at The University of Hong Kong
1st Runner Up - Consensus Web3 Aptos Hackathon 2025
Top 20 - University Startup World Cup 2022
Top 6 - Hult Prize Startup Asia 2022

How long have the founders known one another and how did you meet? Have any of the founders not met in person?

We met at HKU in Hong Kong over 4 years ago. Started as hackathon partners, became best friends. We've built and shipped 6+ products together since — a study platform we sold for \$50K, a LinkedIn Chrome extension that got us a cease-and-desist from LinkedIn's legal team, a test-prep app, web agency projects, and now EngageKit.

We work from different countries (Vietnam and Malaysia) but talk every day, build async, and meet up regularly. Even when products fail and we're broke, neither of us has ever considered finding other co-founders. We just like building together too much.

Who writes code, or does other technical work on your product? Was any of it done by a non-founder? Please explain.

Both write code. No contractors, no hires, just us.

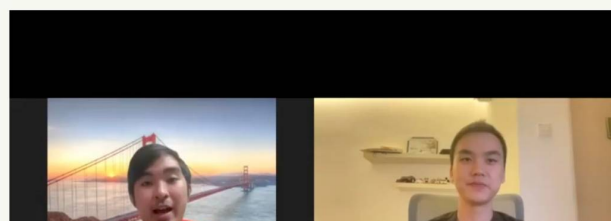
Lam (CTO): core infra — AI pipeline, Chrome extension backend, DB, API, analytics. Ex-AWS solutions architect, contributed to a Nasdaq IPO.

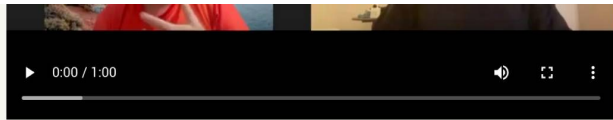
Ky-Nam (CEO): frontend, user-facing features, all distribution. Built a 40M-impression personal brand with \$0 spend.

Are you looking for a cofounder?

No. But open to the idea.

Founder Video





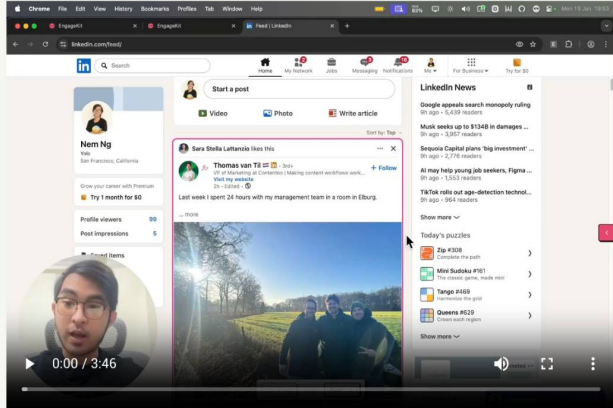
Company

Company name
EngageKit

Describe what your company does in 50 characters or less.
Authentic Engagement on LinkedIn for founders

Company URL, if any
<https://engagekit.io>

Demo Video



Please provide a link to the product, if any.
<https://chromewebstore.google.com/detail/engagekit/gnaedgbedhaolekfeiniekhccpaii>

Unanswered

What is your company going to make? Please describe your product and what it does or will do.

We are making EngageKit - the world's only LinkedIn engagement platform focusing on real authentic engagement that helps founders and teams build real connections.

Commenting on others' posts is the highest-ROI B2B growth activity on LinkedIn (1.3B members, 310M MAU). Takes 1-2 hrs/day to do well.

Current tools either auto-spam (LinkedIn banning them — killed Kleo, killed Lempod, 23% account restriction rate) or help you write your own posts but don't touch engagement.

We're the only human-in-the-loop tool. Build target lists, load their posts into a sidebar feed, get AI drafts informed by post + thread + your persona.

Every interaction logged — next time you meet that person, full context. AI makes you faster. You stay in control.

Where do you live now, and where would the company be based after YC?

Vietnam / Malaysia now. SF after YC.

Explain your decision regarding location.

We'll both relocate to SF for the batch and stay after. Our customers are global from day one — LinkedIn engagement is the same in SF, London, or Singapore.

Being in the US puts us next to the highest concentration of founders, growth teams, and VCs who are our core users.

Progress

How far along are you?

We're live on the Chrome Web Store. 1,000 installs, 500 MAU, 50 DAU — all organic, zero ad spend, driven by Ky-Nam's personal brand (40M+ impressions across LinkedIn, X, Reddit, and Threads).

Pricing: \$29.99/month per LinkedIn account. Free plan with 20 AI generations/day, paid is unlimited. Organizations can subscribe multiple accounts.

Next: activate full distribution (Product Hunt launch, targeted outreach to agency and sales teams), ship org-level features for multi-seat accounts, start building CRM integrations.

How long have each of you been working on this? How much of that has been full-time? Please explain.

Full-time since Nov 2025 — that's when we pivoted from GeekGrind (test-prep app, zero paying users) to EngageKit. Both of us are 100% on this. No side gigs, no jobs, nothing else.

Before May 2025, we were building products together full-time for about a year (both quit our jobs in early 2024). Before that, Lam was at Luda Development (contributed to their Nasdaq IPO) and AWS, while Ky-Nam was running SAYU Studio and shipping side projects.

What tech stack are you using, or planning to use, to build this product? Include AI models and AI coding tools you use.

Frontend: Next.js, TailwindCSS + shadcn/ui, WXT Chrome Extension framework

Browser layer: Custom pipeline built on Chrome extension APIs

AI: Gemini (routing across Claude, GPT-4o, Gemini) for comment generation with persona-based prompting and contextual awareness (reads post + adjacent comments + engagement history)

Dev tools: Claude for coding and architecture decisions

Optional: attach a coding agent session you're particularly proud of.

Claude Code Conversation Transcript

Social Referral System Implementation

Feature: Viral growth mechanism where users earn premium access by sharing EngageKit on social media

Date: January-February 2026

Transcript ID: f321dfb7-6cf6-4f84-8cf9-d86eee8170a7

User Message #1

<ide_opened_file>The user opened the file /Users/lnamnguyen/Documents/O-Programming/engagekit-turborepo/apps/nextjs/src/app/(new-dashboard)/[orgSlug]/[accountSlug]/earn-premium/page.tsx in the IDE. This may or may not be related to the current task.</ide_opened_file>

[image attached]

help me understand the icons here i don't understand what M A D or arrow down mean?

this happened after i pulled and merged my cofounder code changes from github

Claude Response #1

Are people using your product?
Yes

How many active users or customers do you have? How many are paying? Who is paying you the most, and how much do they pay you?
1,000 installs, 500 monthly active users, 50 daily active. 5 paying users at \$29.99/month. Lifetime, 80 users have paid to use our products but we struggled with churns.

Our highest-paying users are agency owners who operate LinkedIn accounts and build personal brands for other execs and founders — they pay \$29.99/month per account and are our stickiest users because EngageKit directly powers their client deliverables.

In the upcoming weeks, we have booked meetings with multiple dozens personal brand and agency owners to pitch them our product and be more active on the sales pipelines.

Do you have revenue?
yes

How much revenue do you have?

Jan 2026	\$199
Dec 2025	\$194
Nov 2025	\$304
Oct 2025	\$255
Sep 2025	\$419
Aug 2025	\$126

Where does your revenue come from? If your revenue comes from multiple sources (e.g., multiple products, multiple companies or a mix of consulting and this product), please break down how much is coming from each source.
Subscription from the product.

Anything else you would like us to know regarding your revenue or growth rate?

We rebuilt the product from scratch and relaunched 3 weeks ago. Rolled out paid plans on the new version and already have 5 paying users with multiple agency meetings in the pipeline. \$1,500 lifetime revenue, ~\$200 current MRR. We haven't done a real launch yet — no Product Hunt, no outreach, no sales. Everything so far is inbound.

Growth has been driven almost entirely by Ky-Nam's personal brand — he's built 40M+ impressions across X, LinkedIn, Reddit, and Threads writing about building startups from Vietnam. \$0 ad spend. We haven't done a proper product launch (no Product Hunt, no launch campaign), haven't started sales outreach, and haven't activated most of our distribution channels yet. Current growth is 50-100 new users per month from content alone.

If you are applying with the same idea as a previous batch, did anything change? If you applied with a different idea, why did you pivot and what did you learn from the last idea?
This is our third YC application. Each one taught us something specific.

Application 1 (W23): LEAN Social — study-together platform with gamification for GenZ students. We assembled a large team of volunteers, won competitions, got 5,000 users, built a community of 50K members. But our product sucked.

What we learned: B2C for broke students is brutal. And a big team of volunteers creates more distraction than output. Ship first, celebrate later.

Application 2 (S25): GeekGrind — "Leetcode for standardized tests" powered by AI. We built it lean this time (just the two of us), launched, got signups. Zero paying users. We were building in education because we used to tutor, not because we were obsessed with the problem.

What we learned: build something you use every day and would pay for yourself.

Application 3 (S26): EngageKit - Before GeekGrind, Ky-Nam built Linkstrip, a Chrome extension that hacked LinkedIn's feed. It got big enough that LinkedIn's legal team sent a cease-and-desist. That C&D taught us exactly where LinkedIn draws the line on third-party tools.

EngageKit is built on that lesson. We use it every day. We know the domain — Ky-Nam has 40M+ impressions from organic content, and both of us are power LinkedIn users who felt the pain firsthand. We're just two founders now, no volunteers, no competitions — 100% focused on shipping features and talking to users.

If you have already participated or committed to participate in an incubator, "accelerator" or "pre-accelerator" program, please tell us about it.

Hong Kong Science and Technology Parks Corporation — startup grant, \$14K USD, no equity. Hong Kong Cyberport — startup grant, \$14K USD, no equity. Neither has restrictions on joining YC.

Idea

Why did you pick this idea to work on? Do you have domain expertise in this area? How do you know people need what you're making?

Three reasons:

1. We got a cease-and-desist from LinkedIn. That experience gave us deep knowledge of LinkedIn's platform rules, enforcement patterns, and exactly where the line is. EngageKit is designed to live permanently on the right side of it.

2. We're power users of our own product. Ky-Nam built a 40M+ impression personal brand across LinkedIn, X, Reddit, and Threads with \$0 ad spend. He uses EngageKit daily. We know what authentic engagement looks like because we've done it — for ourselves and for agency clients (\$100K revenue from content-driven leads).

3. LinkedIn is the best global B2B platform, not just for tech but for every industry. We see founders, sales teams, consultants, and recruiters all needing the same thing: faster engagement that feels real - because it is :)

People need this because LinkedIn engagement is the highest-ROI activity for B2B growth, but doing it manually takes 1-2 hours/day. Our users cut that to 15-20 minutes while actually reading every post and knowing who they're talking to.

Who are your competitors? What do you understand about your business that they don't?

The market is splitting into three categories — and we're the only one in the category that survives:

1. Fully automated bots (dying): Expandi (\$10.7M ARR), Dripify, Waalaxy, Octopus CRM. Auto-send connection requests and messages. LinkedIn is actively killing this category.

2. Content creation tools (adjacent, not competitive): Taplio (acquired by Lemlist for their \$40M ARR empire), AuthoredUp, Shield. These help you write your own posts. They don't touch engagement on other people's content — which is where relationships and pipeline actually get built.

2. Auto-commenting tools: Kleo (C&D from LinkedIn, 2025), Lempod (permanently removed from Chrome Web Store), HyperClapper, PowerIn. Auto-post AI comments without human review. The comments are generic, LinkedIn's ML catches them, and the person operating the account doesn't even know what they're commenting on.

3. EngageKit (only human-in-the-loop tool): AI drafts, human approves. You actually read the post. You know who the person is. You control the history. LinkedIn can't ban us for the same reason they can't ban Grammarly — we're an authoring tool, not a bot.

The problem with AI slop on LinkedIn isn't that it's AI — it's that it's mindless. The operator has no idea who they're interacting with. Our entire engine is designed around the opposite: making sure you read the post, know the person, and make the interaction count. The engagement history isn't a feature — it's the product philosophy.

How do or will you make money? How much could you make?

Current: \$29.99/month per LinkedIn account. Free tier with 20 AI generations/day, paid is unlimited. ~\$200 MRR from 5 paying users (\$1,500 lifetime revenue). Our highest-paying users are agency owners who operate LinkedIn accounts and build personal brands for other execs and founders.

Near-term: Multi-seat org subscriptions for growth teams (5-20 people × \$29.99/seat/month). Annual plans at \$299/year. Target: \$100K+ MRR within 6 months.

Long term, with LinkedIn's growing 300M active users - we expect a TAM of around \$50 billion.

Which category best applies to your company?

Sales Enablement

If you had any other ideas you considered applying with, please list them. One may be something we've been waiting for. Often when we fund people it's to do something they list here and not in the main application.

1. Flowser — pre-built browser automations for AI agents, exposed as MCP tools.

AI agents can call APIs but can't reliably interact with websites — they hallucinate selectors or burn tokens on vision-based browsing. Playwright MCP gives agents a raw browser (steering wheel, no roads). Flowser gives them tested routes: a curated registry of Playwright scripts exposed as one MCP server. Agent calls search_workflows("scrape Amazon product") → gets back structured JSON. Three tool calls, deterministic results.

We write the workflows ourselves (no cold-start problem), starting with 30-50 high-demand automations. Open-source runtime, pay-per-execution for cloud. Playwright gets 20M+ weekly npm downloads, 5,800+ MCP servers exist, nobody has built reusable browser workflows agents can call out of the box.

2. Chatstack — Substack for group chats.

Syncs messages from any group chat (WhatsApp, Telegram, Discord) into a dashboard with participation analytics, AI summaries, search, and paywall features. Built on Matrix protocol. We built it for our buildstuffs.com community (1,000+ builders) and realized every paid community has the same problem: the value is in the chats, but chats are unsearchable, unmeasurable, and unmonetizable.

Equity

Have you formed ANY legal entity yet?

yes

Please list all legal entities you have and in what state or country each was formed (e.g. Delaware C Corp, Mexican SAPI, Singapore Pvt Ltd, etc.).

Hong Kong LLC. Will convert to Delaware C-Corp if accepted to YC.

founders, employees and any other stockholders. If there are multiple founders, be sure to give the equity ownership of each founder and founder title (e.g. CEO).

50/50 between Ky-Nam and Lam.

Have you taken any investment yet?

no

Are you currently fundraising?

no

Curious

What convinced you to apply to Y Combinator? Did someone encourage you to apply? Have you been to any YC events?

We've been following YC founders and partners for years — Garry Tan's talks on founder-market fit, Dalton Caldwell on pivots, Michael Seibel on application strategy. Their thinking has shaped how we build.

What really got us was Paul Graham's original vision for YC — a hacker house where builders support builders. No corporate theater, just nerdy people shipping code and helping each other grow. That philosophy is exactly what I (Ky-Nam) have been trying to build in Vietnam and Southeast Asia with buildstuffs.com — 1,000+ builders, 50+ co-building sessions across 3 cities, inspired by the PayPal Mafia model where founders who come up together keep supporting each other long after. Very bootstrap, very hacky, very nerdy. YC is the original version of that, and we want to be part of it.

We also know YC-backed founders in the region. Jun Yuan Tan from Homebase (YC-backed, Ho Chi Minh City) has seen our product firsthand — we demoed EngageKit to him in person and update him on our progress regularly. He's been encouraging us to apply. We also connected with the Marathon Education founders on LinkedIn, who shared their experience going through YC as Vietnamese founders and encouraged us to go for it.

This is our third application. We're not applying because we need permission. We're applying because EngageKit is the first product where our domain expertise, distribution ability, and technical skills all converge — and YC is the best network in the world to scale it.

How did you hear about Y Combinator?

Hacker News and Reddit, years ago. We follow YC partners closely — Garry Tan, Michael Seibel, Dalton Caldwell. Jun Yuan Tan (Homebase, Ho Chi Minh City) and the Marathon Education founders both encouraged us to apply.

Batch Preference

What batch do you want to apply for?

current

Invited

List each founder's citizenship(s).

Ky Nam Nguyen - Vietnamese
Zi Hao Lam - Malaysian

Are any of the founders covered by noncompetes or intellectual property agreements that overlap with your project? If so, please explain.

No

Is there anything else we should know about your company? Pending lawsuits, cofounders who have left, etc.

No